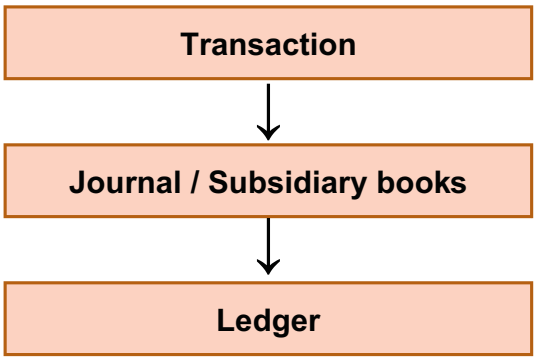
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4.1 Introduction



Student activity

Think: A trader has been selling goods both on cash and credit bases. Most of the goods are sold on credit. The owner has lost track of 'who has to pay how much?' Is there any quick way to get this information?



Ledger account is a summary statement of all the transactions relating to a person, asset, liability, expense or income which has taken place during a given period of time and it shows their net effect. From the transactions recorded in the journal, the ledger account is prepared. Ledger is known as principal book of accounts. It is a book which contains all sets of accounts, namely, personal, real and nominal accounts. Accountwise balance can be determined from the ledger. The ledger accounts are prepared based on journal entries passed.

The balances in the ledger accounts show the net effect of transactions during a particular period in various accounts. The personal accounts give the net amount due to creditors and the net amount due from debtors, real accounts show the values of assets and nominal accounts show incomes and expenses. The financial statements can be prepared from the ledger balances.

Ledger may be maintained in the business enterprises in the form of a bound register or in the form of loose sheets with spiral binding. Normally one page or one sheet may be provided for one account. An index is provided in the beginning of the ledger giving details of the accounts contained in it such as specific code for each account, page number, etc. Where computerised accounting is followed, once the transactions are recorded in the journal, ledger accounts are automatically prepared.

4.2. Utilities of ledger

Following are the utilities of ledger:

i) Quick information about a particular account

Ledger account helps to get all information about a particular account like sales, purchases, machinery, etc., at a glance. For example, where there are several transactions with a debtor, the net amount due from a debtor can be known from the ledger account.

ii) Control over business transactions

From the ledger balances extracted, a thorough analysis of account balances can be made which helps to have control over the business transactions.